

You can also compare two versions of the document under the “Compare Two Revisions” link. This presents two drop-down lists from where you can choose the versions.

Finally, a “Revision History” link presents a listing of the Time, and the Author who modified the document. Since the work of each author is differently coloured, they can be easily differentiated.

4.2.5 Additional Tweaking

The Edit HTML tab allows you to modify the HTML code underlying every document. This could be used by people with the relevant knowledge to add effects not provided by the interface—like the ability to merge adjacent cells of a table, or use a text size not on offer.

4.2.6 Collaboration

To add viewers or other editors, use the Collaborators tab. Here, you can add collaborators by their e-mail addresses. Clicking on the “Invite these people” button doesn’t send any e-mails to the invitees: it only adds their names to the viewers / collaborators list. A prompt requesting permission to send an invitational e-mail comes up after the “Invite these People” button is pressed. The e-mail body can be customised before it is sent; the URL to the document is sent with the invitation. Invitees need to be members of Google Docs to be able to view or collaborate.

One glaring omission in comparison with GS is the lack of an IM client. Without the ability to exchange instant messages, collaboration may not be as effective. You can e-mail contributors or visitors using the E-mail link.

GD supports RSS and feeds for every modification of the document to be accessed. The “View RSS feed of Document Changes” allows viewers and collaborators to be updated every time the document is changed—without having to visit the site. Further RSS configuration is discussed in §4.4.